

Yellowstone & Grand Teton Road Trip

Salt Lake City Loop | 2026.06.13 – 2026.06.20

SLC → Grand Teton → Yellowstone → Idaho Falls → SLC



Lodging Sequence



SLC
1 night



Victor /
Driggs
2 nights



Island
Park
2 nights



Gardiner
1 night



Idaho
Falls
1 night



Trip Highlights



Grand Teton mountain and lake scenery



Yellowstone geysers and Grand Prismatic



Mammoth terraces and Lamar wildlife



Southbound crossing by Yellowstone Lake

Overview Itinerary

Salt Lake City Loop | 2026.06.13 – 2026.06.20

 Date	 Start & Drive In	 Attractions & In-Park Commute	 Lodging	 End & Drive Out
6/13	Arrive at SLC airport / city and pick up rental car, 0 hr	Buy bear spray, water, and snacks 1–1.5 hr; lunch or early dinner 1–1.5 hr	 Salt Lake City	Local errands around town about 0.5 hr
6/14	SLC to south Grand Teton, 4.5–5.5 hr	Taggart Lake (optional, depending on trail and parking conditions) 1.5–2 hr → drive 0.3 hr → Schwabacher Landing 0.5 hr → drive 0.2 hr → Mormon Row 0.5 hr → drive 0.3 hr → Snake River Overlook 0.3 hr	 Victor / Driggs	Over Teton Pass, 0.75–1 hr
6/15	Victor / Driggs to Jenny Lake, 0.75–1.2 hr	Jenny Lake boat round trip / waiting 0.75–1 hr → Hidden Falls + Inspiration Point 1.5 hr → Cascade Canyon short out-and-back 2 hr → drive 0.5 hr → Oxbow Bend 0.5 hr	 Victor / Driggs	Drive back south and over the pass, 1–1.5 hr
6/16	Victor / Driggs through Grand Teton to Yellowstone Southwest, 3.5–4.5 hr	Old Faithful + Upper Geyser Basin 2.5–3 hr → drive 0.3 hr → Grand Prismatic Overlook / Fairy Falls Trail 1.5 hr	 Island Park	From West Entrance to Island Park, 1–1.25 hr
6/17	Island Park to Norris, 1.25–1.75 hr	Norris Geyser Basin 1.5 hr → drive 0.5 hr → Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone / Artist Point 2 hr → drive 0.5 hr → Hayden Valley 1–1.5 hr	 Island Park	Return via West Entrance, 1.5–2 hr
6/18	Island Park to Mammoth, 2.5–3 hr	Mammoth Hot Springs 1.5 hr → out North Entrance 0.3 hr → Gardiner check-in / dinner 1.5 hr → drive 1 hr → Lamar Valley 1.5–2 hr	 Gardiner	Lamar back to Gardiner, 1–1.25 hr
6/19	Gardiner to Yellowstone Lake / West Thumb area, 2.5–3.5 hr	Yellowstone Lake 0.5 hr → drive 0.5 hr → West Thumb Geyser Basin 1 hr → drive 0.5 hr to South Entrance → pass around Grand Teton, no hike	 Idaho Falls	South Entrance to Idaho Falls, 2.5–3.5 hr
6/20	Idaho Falls along I-15 to SLC, 3–3.5 hr	No in-park activities	 SLC airport / city	Return car and depart

 Note: Times are estimates under normal road conditions. Yellowstone traffic, parking, and wildlife may cause delays.

Day 1 | 6/13 Arrive in Salt Lake City

Arrival + Supply Run



Route:

SLC airport / city → local errands



Today's Drive:

0 hr (mostly local city activities)



Lodging:

Salt Lake City



Core Plan:

- 1 Pick up rental car and check license, fuel, and vehicle condition
- 2 Buy bear spray, water, snacks, and breakfast supplies
- 3 Grab a Chinese or Sichuan meal and rest early



Estimated Time:

Shopping 1–1.5 hr;
meal 1–1.5 hr;
local driving about 0.5 hr



Reminder:

Prioritize supplies and rest tonight; tomorrow starts the long-drive rhythm.



Supply Checklist (Recommended)



Bear Spray



Water



Snacks

Day 2 | 6/14 First Look at Grand Teton

SLC → Grand Teton → Victor / Driggs



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In:

4.5–5.5 hr

Drive Out:

0.75–1 hr



Lodging:

Victor / Driggs



In-Park Commute:

about 0.8 hr



Stop Order:

- 1 Taggart Lake (optional, depending on trail and parking conditions) | 1.5–2 hr
- 2 Schwabacher Landing | 0.5 hr
- 3 Mormon Row | 0.5 hr
- 4 Snake River Overlook | 0.3 hr



Today's Highlights:

Your first big Grand Teton views, the classic Mormon Row barn, and the Snake River overlook.



Quick Tip:

Keep today light. If Taggart Lake is crowded, skip it.



Taggart Lake



Snake River Overlook



Suggested Items to Bring:



Bear Spray



Water



Sun Protection
(Sunscreen, Hat,
Sunglasses)



Snacks



Camera

Day 3 | 6/15 Jenny Lake & Canyon Trail

Jenny Lake + Cascade Canyon + Oxbow Bend



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In:
0.75–1.2 hr

Drive Out:
1–1.5 hr



Lodging:

Victor / Driggs



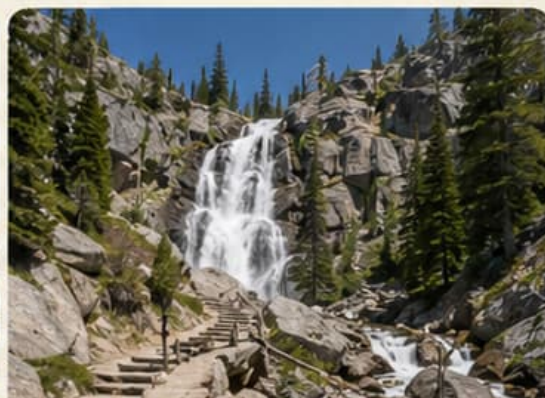
In-Park Commute:

about 0.5 hr



Today's Highlights:

Lake scenery, waterfall, canyon views, and sunset at Oxbow Bend.



Hidden Falls / Inspiration Point



Oxbow Bend



Stop Order

- 1 Jenny Lake boat round trip / waiting | 0.75–1 hr
- 2 Hidden Falls + Inspiration Point | 1.5 hr
- 3 Cascade Canyon (short out-and-back only) | 2 hr
- 4 Oxbow Bend at evening light | 0.5 hr



Quick Tip:



This is a more active day.
Do not go too deep into
Cascade Canyon.

Day 4 | 6/16 Yellowstone Southwest

Old Faithful + Upper Geyser Basin + Grand Prismatic



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In:

3.5–4.5 hr

Drive Out: 1–1.25 hr



In-Park Commute:

about 0.3 hr



Lodging:

Island Park

Old Faithful



Grand Prismatic Overlook



Upper Geyser Basin Boardwalk



Stop Order:

- 1 Old Faithful + Upper Geyser Basin | 2.5–3 hr
- 2 Grand Prismatic Overlook / Fairy Falls Trail | 1.5 hr



Today's Highlights:

Old Faithful eruptions, the Grand Prismatic overlook, and Yellowstone's most iconic geothermal scenery.



Quick Tip:

This is a transfer + sightseeing day.
Do not cram in too many extra small stops.



Day 5 | 6/17 Yellowstone Lower Loop

Norris + Canyon + Hayden Valley



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In: 1.25–1.75 hr
Drive Out: 1.5–2 hr



In-Park Commute:

about 1 hr



Lodging:

Island Park



Stop Order:

- 1 Norris Geyser Basin | 1.5 hr
- 2 Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone / Artist Point | 2 hr
- 3 Hayden Valley (wildlife viewing from the car at dusk) | 1–1.5 hr



Today's Highlights:

Geothermal basin, Yellowstone canyon scenery, and evening wildlife watching.

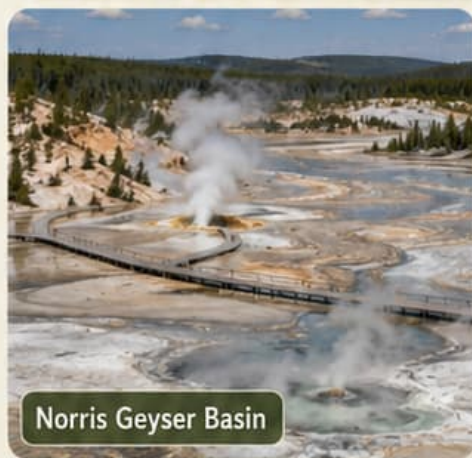


Quick Tip:

Do not stay in Hayden Valley too late; the night drive back to Island Park is more tiring.



Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone / Artist Point



Norris Geyser Basin



Hayden Valley



Packing Checklist (Suggested)



Bear Spray



Water



Camera /
Binoculars



Snacks /
Energy



Warm Layers /
Rain Gear

Day 6 | 6/18 Yellowstone North Transfer Day

Mammoth Hot Springs + Lamar Valley



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In: 2.5–3 hr
Drive Out: 1–1.25 hr



In-Park Commute:

about 1.3 hr



Lodging:

Gardiner



Stop Order:

- 1 Mammoth Hot Springs | 1.5 hr
- 2 Gardiner check-in / dinner | 1.5 hr
- 3 Lamar Valley (wildlife viewing during golden hour) | 1.5–2 hr



Today's Highlights:

Mammoth travertine terraces and Lamar Valley wildlife.



Quick Tip:

Lamar Valley is mostly a drive-and-look experience. You may see bison and elk, and with luck even a bear or wolf.



Reminder:

Enjoy the golden hour in Lamar Valley for the best wildlife viewing.

Day 7 | 6/19 Southbound Crossing by Yellowstone Lake

Yellowstone Lake + West Thumb → Idaho Falls



Today's Drive:

Start & Drive In: 2.5–3.5 hr

Drive Out: 2.5–3.5 hr



Lodging:

Idaho Falls



In-Park Commute:

about 1 hr



Quick Tip:

This is the hardest day of the trip. Keep it focused on driving and catching what you missed; no long hike.



Stop Order:

- 1 Yellowstone Lake
scenic pullouts | 0.5 hr
- 2 West Thumb Geyser Basin | 1 hr
- 3 Exit via the South Entrance
and continue south past
Grand Teton



Today's Highlights:

Lake views, boardwalks, and crossing Yellowstone from north to south.

Day 8 | 6/20 Return to Salt Lake City

Idaho Falls → Salt Lake City



Jenny Lake



Grand Prismatic



Mammoth Hot Springs



Yellowstone Lake



TODAY'S DRIVE:

Start & Drive In: 3–3.5 hr



LODGING:

None (departure day)



TODAY'S PLAN:

- 1 Drive south on I-15 back to SLC
- 2 Return the rental car and organize luggage
- 3 If time allows, have a quick meal in SLC before departure



IN-PARK HIKING:

None



TODAY'S HIGHLIGHTS:

Trip wrap-up and one last look back at the scenery.



QUICK TIP:

Leave enough buffer time for rental car return and airport security.



TRIP RECAP



Core Areas: Grand Teton + Yellowstone



Lodging Sequence: SLC → Victor / Driggs → Island Park → Gardiner → Idaho Falls



Signature Sights: Jenny Lake, Grand Prismatic, Mammoth Hot Springs, Yellowstone Lake



Keywords: road trip, geothermal scenery, mountain lakes, wildlife